

Session 6: The Genesis 1-11 Pattern Throughout Scripture

Key Takeaways

- The biblical authors craft the literary design of the text to make theological arguments.
- Tension between God's justice and his mercy drives the biblical storyline.

Reflecting on the Cyclical Pattern in Genesis 1-11

Unit		Theme
A1	1:1-2:3 Creation of sacred cosmos from chaos waters / human image of God / blessing / fruitful and multiply	Creation and Blessing
B1	2:4-3:24 Mountain-garden temple / sin, nakedness, curse, exile	Failure
B2	4:1-16 Next generation sins / brothers divide / firstborn not chosen / curse, exile	Failure of Next Generation
C1	4:17-26 Adam to Lemek: 7 generations + 3 sons / city of Cain / murder / 70 x 7	Non-Chosen
C2	5:1-32 Adam to Noah: 10 generations + 3 sons / promise of comfort	Chosen
B3	6:1-8 Cosmic rebellion in Heaven and Earth: sons of God invade the land, leading to the flood	Cosmic Rebellion
A2	6:9-9:19 De-creation by chaos waters and recreation / Noah as new humanity / blessing / fruitful and multiply	Re-Creation and Blessing
B1	9:20-21 Garden vineyard / sin, nakedness	Failure
Macro-Design of Genesis 1-11. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Adam to Noah (2020).		

Unit			Theme
	B2	9:22-27 Next generation sins / brothers divide / firstborn not chosen / curse, scattering	Failure of Next Generation
	C1	10:1-32 Noah + 3 sons / 7 generations to Peleg / City of Babylon and Assyria / 70 nations	Non-Chosen
	B3	11:1-9 Cosmic rebellion in Babylon: sons of Adam invade the heavens, leading to the scattering	Cosmic Rebellion
	C2	11:10-26 Shem to Abram: 10 generations / 3 sons	Chosen
A3		12:1-9 Abram as new humanity / blessing / fruitful and multiply	Re-Creation and Blessing
Macro-Design of Genesis 1-11. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Adam to Noah (2020).			



This session has no other notes

Reflection Question

Genesis 1-11 introduces a tension between God's justice and mercy. Think of God's just judgment and exile of Cain in tension with the mercy of protecting Cain's life. Is this a contradiction? What do you think this says about the character of God?